What this workbook covers 本册讲什么

One simple task — which line matches? — asked out loud in front of a group who are all deliberately wrong. This booklet walks through **three series of experiments** (1951, 1952, 1956), every variation with its exact figure, the evaluation the exam rewards, and how to write the 8-mark answer.

How to use this booklet 怎么用

1. **Fill it in as you go.** Write the word or number in the blank before checking the answer key.
2. **The answer key is at the back (pp. 19–20).** Cover it. Check after each page.
3. **Pages 12–13 (numbers) and 16–18 (exam) matter most.** Do them from memory, under time.

Content map 内容地图

Page	Topic	What you must be able to do afterwards
p.2	The task and the design 设计	Explain why an obvious answer is the whole point (NSI, not ISI)
p.3–4	Asch (1951) procedure + results	Describe the baseline in 4 sentences; quote 32% / 68% correctly
p.5	Broken majorities 破裂多数	Quote 10.4% and 5.5% and explain social support
p.6	Majority size 多数规模	Quote 12.8% at two; the peak at three; nothing beyond
p.7–8	Asch (1952) 异议者	Quote 33.2% vs 7.4%; the four 1952 variations
p.9–10	Asch (1956) 经典版	123 students; control of 37 gave 3 errors; compromise response; discs 39%
p.11	Side by side 三年对照	Fill the full comparison table
p.12	Every number 数字收口	Cover the right column and test yourself
p.13–14	Evaluation 评价	Two strengths, four limitations, each with a consequence
p.15	Improvements 改进题	Weakness → improvement → justification, ready to reuse
p.16	Exam skills 答题技巧	Command words, marks, sentence frames
p.17–18	Practice A & B 演练	Short answers, then the 8-mark evaluation
p.19–20	Answer key 答案速查	Mark honestly, then re-write wrong answers in full

Revision tracker 复习打卡

☐ p.2–4 baseline ☐ p.5–6 variations 1951 ☐ p.7–8 Asch 1952 ☐ p.9–10 Asch 1956 ☐ p.11–12 numbers ☐ p.13–15 evaluation ☐ p.16–18 exam

The whole chapter in one sentence 全章一句话

When a **unanimous** majority deliberately gave an obviously wrong answer, **32% of responses followed** — but break the unanimity with **one ally** (5.5–13%), shrink or grow the majority past **three**, or let the participant answer **in private** (7.4–12.5%), and conformity collapses: people yield to **normative pressure**, not to information.

§1 · The task, and why the obvious answer is the point

ANSWERS → p.19

The setup

Solomon Asch conducted a series of _____ experiments designed to test _____ influence on conformity — the factors which affect conformity levels. Typically, ____ naive participant was placed in a group of _____ to see whether they would conform to the group norm.（type of experiment / majority / who else is in the group）

The task

Match the length of a _____ line with one of ____ comparison lines of unequal length — one of which matched the standard line. The correct answer is _____.（what you look at / how many / how hard is it）

中文理解：为什么“答案明显”是整个设计的核心

1.1.4 里 Sherif 用的是**模糊任务**（没人知道光点动了多远）—— 从众可以说是“为了获得正确信息”（ISI）。
Asch 反着来：答案一眼就能看出对错。这时候再从众，唯一的解释就是**规范性社会影响 NSI** —— 屈服于压力，而不是寻找信息。
两个实验放在一起记：**Sherif = 模糊任务 → ISI；Asch = 明显任务 → NSI**。

Key terms before you start 先弄懂两个词

Term	Definition
confederate 同谋者	_____
control group 控制组	_____

Self-check 自查

1. In one sentence: why does conformity in Asch's task have to be normative rather than informational?

2. Asch's three series (1951, 1952, 1956) share one basic procedure. What changes between them?

§2 · Asch (1951) — the baseline procedure

ANSWERS → p.19

These facts are a complete 4-mark "describe" answer. Fill every blank, then memorise the sequence.

Detail	What happened
Sample	____ male college students, put into groups of ____.
The task	Judge which of ____ comparison lines matched the standard line, answering _____.
The deception	Unknown to ____ participant, the other ____ members were _____ who responded with a wrong answer.
The pressure	The naive participant faced a group that _____ selected the incorrect line.
Trials	There were ____ critical trials in which the group answered wrongly.
The measure	The _____ of incorrect responses made by the participant was calculated as the measure of conformity.
Afterwards	The participant was immediately _____ and _____ as to the true nature of the study.

中文理解：四个必须写准的细节

① 50 名男大学生；② 每组 8 人，其中 **7 个是同谋者**、只有 1 个真被试；③ 答案**公开说出**（压力来源）；④ 12 次“关键试验”全员故意说错。

测量方式 = **错误回答的比例**（error rate）—— 这个客观测量是评价里的优点。

Write it out 默写

Close this page. In four sentences, describe the baseline procedure. Include: sample · the roles · the public answers · the measure.

§3 · Asch (1951) — the results

ANSWERS → p.19

The numbers

Over the 12 critical trials, _____% of estimates made were errors in line with the majority's incorrect response. Despite the majority pressure, _____% of estimates were correct.

Exam trap 考试陷阱

The result is "**32% of responses** given were errors" — *not* 32% of participants and *not* 32% of trials. The textbook checkpoint question tests exactly this distinction. Tick the right one:

32% of participants made errors 32% of responses were errors 32% of trials were errors

The finding inside the average

There were strong _____ differences: some participants conformed in _____ every trial and some _____ conformed. (what kind of differences)

Those who kept their independence did so because they were _____, maintained _____, or maintained _____. Those who conformed were thought to lack _____ or to want to _____ into the group.

The conclusion

Asch concluded that conformity could only be explained by a _____ of _____ pressure and the _____'s response in that situation.

中文理解：怎么读 32% 这个数字

正着读：三分之一的回答跟着多数人错 —— 压力真实存在。

反着读：68% 的回答是对的 —— 大多数时候人们顶住了。

两个方向都要会写：评价题常考"结果其实显示人们大部分时间没从众"。

Exam sentence 背这一句

"Over 12 critical trials, _____% of the naive participants' responses followed the majority's deliberate error, which demonstrates _____ social influence — although _____% of responses were still correct, and individuals differed widely."

§4 · Asch (1951) — broken majorities and social support

ANSWERS → p.19

Variation	Error rate	What it shows
____ naive participants in the group, both answering against six confederates.	_____	A broken majority reduces conformity.
One naive participant + one _____ who gave the correct answer, against six wrong ones.	_____	The partner acts as _____ against the majority.
The partner _____ midway through the trials.	conformity _____	Losing support causes loss of independence.
The partner first conformed, then _____ midway and gave correct answers.	reduced but _____	People find it difficult to switch from conforming to independent behaviour.

Read the numbers like a psychologist

Seven wrong answers against you → _____% conformity. Just _____ person agreeing with you → conformity collapses to _____%. The drop shows that most of the majority's power comes from being _____ — once one person breaks ranks, the spell breaks.

中文理解：只要一个人站在你这边

七个人说错、你一个人说对 → 32% 从众；多**一个盟友** → 掉到 **5.5%**。

这就是 **social support（社会支持）**。考试问“how could Asch's findings be applied”，这是最好的应用点（工作、学校里做“第一个说真话的人”价值巨大）。

Don't mix these up 别混

_____% = two naive participants (1951). _____% = one ally answering correctly (1951). _____% = two confederates as the majority (1951 size series).

Exam sentence

“When one confederate answered correctly, errors fell from 32% to _____%, showing that a partner acts as _____ against the majority influence.”

§5 · Asch (1951) — the size of the majority

ANSWERS → p.19

Participants were placed into groups with a unanimous majority of _____ confederates — all giving the same wrong answer.

Majority size	Result	Reading
1	_____	One person is not a majority.
2	wrong line chosen _____ % of times	Conformity begins.
3	_____	The peak.
4, 8, 16	_____	Larger majorities add nothing.

Connect to 1.1.4 联回理论

这正是 Latané 灯泡类比的数据版（social impact theory 的 force of **number**）：第一颗灯泡最亮，之后每颗增亮递减。

考试把 1.1.4 的理论和 1.1.5 的数据连起来写（“Asch's size series supports the number force of SIT…”）是 AO3 的高级操作。

Sketch it 画一遍

Draw the bars for majority sizes 1, 2, 3 and 16 (label the 12.8% and mark the peak at 3):

Numbers check

1. Majority of 2 → _____ % errors. 2. Peak at a majority of _____. 3. Majority of 16 vs 8: _____

§6 · Asch (1952) — the dissenter and the private control

ANSWERS → p.19

What was different

Male college students in groups of _____ to ____ — and this time the participants were _____, chosen as such by the confederate majority. The majority answered correctly for the first two trials. On the third trial, one individual _____. He sometimes repeats this dissent, and sometimes agrees with the incorrect response. (acquaintances or strangers? / what does he claim)

Results

Condition	Error rate
Public answers, dissenter questions the majority	_____ %
Control group — answers written in _____	_____ %

Why this matters

The dissenter had _____ the majority's judgement — so participants could not be conforming because they believed the majority was _____. They were _____ to social pressure.

中文理解：这组对照为什么值钱

公开回答：**33.2%** 错；私下写答案：**7.4%** 错。同一批人、同一套题，唯一区别是要不要当众说 —— 差距就是 NSI 的直接证据。

再加一层：这次明明有人**公开质疑过**多数的判断，大家还是照样从众 —— “我不知道正确答案”这条借口被彻底排除。

Exam sentence

“In the 1952 series, _____% of responses followed the majority even though a dissenter had questioned their judgement, while the private control group erred on only _____% — showing participants were _____ to social pressure rather than relying on the majority for information.”

§7 · Asch (1952) — the four variations

ANSWERS → p.19

Variation	Result	What it shows
The majority chose a line _____ different from the standard.	errors fell slightly to _____	Obvious wrongness barely dents majority influence.
The majority reduced to ____ single person.	effect _____	One person is not a majority — the participant _____ them.
One group member _____ gave the correct answer against the majority.	conformity fell to _____	A consistent ally breaks the majority's power — though some abandoned the partner for the majority.
A majority of ____ naive participants with a single wrong responder.	_____	A lone minority has no power — the single member was mocked and suspected of deliberate error.

Conclusion of 1952

"We are still likely to _____ to majority influence when it is _____ and when it is obviously _____."

中文理解：四个变式一句话收

错得离谱照样跟（27.2%）；一个人不算多数（归零）；一个坚定盟友减半（13%）；反过来一个人对十六个真被试，只会被嘲笑 —— **力量全在"多数"这两个字上**。

最后一个变式留个钩子：一个人怎么才能反过来影响多数？那是 1.1.6 Moscovici 少数派影响的问题。

Numbers drill 数字快测

Obviously different line → _____ majority of one → _____ one consistent ally → _____ lone wrong responder vs 16 → _____

§8 · Asch (1956) — the classic version

ANSWERS → p.19

Procedure

_____ college students in groups of _____ to nine. The naive participant sat in the _____ chair. Across ____ critical trials the majority's wrong answer was either _____ or _____ different from the standard line. Public answers were compared against a _____ group who wrote their judgements privately.

Results

- The control group of ____ private responders gave only ____ incorrect judgements in total — versus about _____ of responses wrong in the experimental group.
- When the majority chose a _____ different (incorrect) line, naive participants also made a _____ selection.
- With an _____ judgement, _____ modelled the judgement and _____ made a _____ — selecting the moderately different line instead.
- Again: some maintained absolute _____, some yielded _____.

> **中文理解：“妥协”这个细节最值钱**
> 多数人指着一个极端错的答案，五分之一的人不是照抄、而是选了个**折中的错误** —— 压力之下人会真的**扭曲自己的判断**，不是简单复制别人的答案。写 evaluation 或 application 时这是很鲜活的细节。

Exam sentence

“In the 1956 study, the private control group of 37 participants made only ____ errors, while about one third of public answers followed the majority — showing the errors were produced by _____ social influence rather than the difficulty of the task.”

§9 · Asch (1956) continued — discs and privacy

ANSWERS → p.19

Beyond lines: the coloured discs

To test whether conformity extended to other perceived stimuli, participants judged whether a comparison _____ was brighter or darker than a standard. Over 12 trials where the group deliberately judged wrongly, _____ % of the naive participants' responses were incorrect.

The privacy variation

When the group judged _____ but the naive participant answered _____, conformity dropped to just _____ % incorrect estimates.

The conclusions of the 1956 series

- Participants were complying because of _____ social influence.
- _____ factors — social support and the size of the majority — influence conformity rates.
- _____ differences between people also affect how they respond.

The four numbers of 1952, side by side 记住这四根柱子

Condition (1952)	Error rate
Public, unanimous majority	_____
Obviously wrong line	_____
One consistent ally	_____
Private written answers (control)	_____

中文理解：一张表记住 1952

33.2（公开·全体说错）→ 27.2（错得离谱）→ 13（有一个盟友）→ 7.4（私下写）。

这四个数字就是 Asch 研究的骨架 —— 任何 describe / evaluate 题都从这里取材。

Sort them 排序

7.4% · 39% · 32% · 12.5% → highest first: _____（并注明各属哪个年份/条件）

§10 · Side by side — 1951 · 1952 · 1956

ANSWERS → p.20

	Asch (1951)	Asch (1952)	Asch (1956)
Sample	_____	Groups of _____, acquaintances	_____ students
Aim focus	Does a _____ wrong majority produce conformity?	Does conformity survive when the majority is _____?	Does conformity survive an _____ answer? Other stimuli?
Key result	_____ % of responses were errors; _____ % correct	_____ % vs _____ % private control	≈ one third errors; control of 37 gave _____ errors
Variations	two naive → _____; one ally → _____; majority of 3 = _____	obvious line → _____; majority of 1 → _____; one ally → _____	extreme line: 4/5 _____, 1/5 _____; discs → _____; private → _____
Conclusion	_____	_____	_____

锚点记忆法

三个年份最容易混。记三个锚点，变式数字挂在锚点下面：

1951 = 32%（基线）· **1952 = 33.2% vs 7.4%**（异议者 + 私下对照）· **1956 = 123 人 + 圆盘 39%**。

What the three show together 三条总结

1 · People yield to _____, not information（异议者质疑后仍 33.2% 从众；私下几乎不出错）。
2 · The situation can be _____（一致性、盟友、规模、明显度、公开 vs 私下，每个都朝可预测的方向移动错误率）。
3 · The _____ still matters（每个研究都有从不从众和几乎每次都从众的人）。

§11 · Every number on one page

Cover the right column and test yourself

Clue	Answer
Baseline sample (1951)	50 male students, groups of 8
Confederates per group (1951)	7 (only 1 naive participant)
Critical trials with wrong answers (1951)	12
Errors in line with the majority (1951)	32% of responses
Correct responses (1951)	68%
Two naive participants vs six confederates	10.4% errors
One correct-answering confederate (1951)	5.5% errors
Two confederates as the majority	12.8% errors
Peak majority size	3 confederates (larger added nothing)
1952 public error rate (with dissenter present)	33.2%
1952 private written control	7.4%
Obviously different line (1952)	27.2%
One consistent correct ally (1952)	13%
Lone wrong responder vs 16 naive	no impact — mocked, suspected of deliberate error
1956 sample	123 college students, groups of 7–9, naive in second-to-last seat
1956 private control result	37 participants, only 3 incorrect judgements
Extreme line in 1956	4/5 modelled it; 1/5 compromised (moderately wrong)
Coloured discs error rate (1956)	39%
Private answer while group answers publicly (1956)	12.5%
Mori and Arai (2010) finding	With familiar confederates, males (not females) were less likely to be swayed

Self-test routine

Fold this page so only the left column shows. Say the answer out loud before moving down. Mark any row you cannot answer, then re-learn only those rows.

Three “12” numbers — sort them out

_____ % = two confederates as the majority (1951 size series) · _____ % = two naive participants (1951 broken majority) · _____ % = naive participant answers privately (1956).

§12 · Evaluating Asch — strengths

ANSWERS → p.20

Strength	What the point is	Consequence 它带来什么
STANDARDISED **高度标准化**	All participants were given the same line-judgement tasks in exactly the _____ way, and conformity was measured with the objective measure of _____ rate.	_____
INTERNAL VALIDITY **内部效度**	The highly standardised, controlled nature means the error rates were affected only by the _____ and not any other variable.	_____

The sentence frame 万能句式

"A strength is that the procedure was **[point]**. This means **[reliability / internal validity]**, so **[what we can trust about the findings]**."

Write both out 练两句

1 · Standardisation → reliability:

2 · Control → internal validity:

Bonus links 顺手连理论

Asch 的多数规模数据（峰值在 3）还支持 1.1.4 的 **social impact theory**（number 的作用递减）。评价题里跨章引用是加分项。

§13 · Evaluating Asch — limitations

ANSWERS → p.20

Limitation	What the point is	Consequence 对结论做了什么
ECOLOGICAL VALIDITY 生态效度	We cannot be sure findings extend beyond a _____ — conformity to a trivial _____ judgement may occur in the lab, but real-life decisions hold greater importance.	_____
ETHICS 伦理	Participants were _____ about the other group members, and put under considerable _____ when giving public judgements against the majority. But these breaches were a _____ part of the procedure.	_____
FAMILIAR GROUPS 熟人群体	Conformity usually exists in groups of _____, not strangers. _____ (2010) replicated with participants who knew the confederates: _____ (but not females) were less likely to be swayed.	_____
STABILITY 跨时代文化	Asch tested _____ male university students during the _____s. Research with different populations in different decades has _____ produced the same conformity rates.	_____

写法模板：不要列清单

差："Asch only tested American men."（信息正确但没有评价）

好："Because Asch tested only American male students in the 1950s, and later studies with other populations found different rates, we cannot treat 32% as a fixed human constant — the figure is time- and culture-bound."

差别就在最后一句 **what it does to the conclusion**。

Balance it 收口

Two sentences: do the strengths (standardisation, internal validity) outweigh the limitations, or not? Give a judgement.

§14 · Improving the study — the exam's favourite question

ANSWERS → p.20

The exam may ask **how the study could be improved**. Method: take a weakness → turn it into an improvement → **justify why it is an improvement**. The textbook gives you two ready-made answers:

Improvement 改进	**Justification 理由（课本原文句式）**
Use a more _____ sample that also includes _____ participants instead of just the 50 male students.	This would make his findings about conformity to a majority group more _____ to a wider target population.
A more _____ task, such as providing _____ of real objects, could be used to test conformity.	This would increase the _____ of Asch's findings about conformity in real-life situations.
Use _____ groups rather than strangers (as Mori and Arai did).	This would better reflect how conformity operates in _____ group settings.

中文理解：改进题的三段套路

弱点 → 改进 → 理由。弱点必须是真弱点（伦理不算——难以既消除又保留程序）；改进要可操作；理由落到 **generalisability / validity** 这类评价词上。
背熟课本的两个例句，考场上换内容即可。

Your third one 补一条你自己的

Improvement: _____

Justification:

Sentence frames

“One improvement would be to **[change]**.” “This is an improvement because it would make the findings more **[generalisable / valid]**, which means **[what we could then conclude]**.”

§15 · Exam skills — command words, marks, sentence frames

USE WITH pp. 17–18

Command words 指令词

Word	What it wants	What NOT to do
Describe	Who, where, what they did, and the key **numbers**. Pure AO1.	Do not evaluate or give opinions.
Explain	Why, or what it means — one point plus one reason per mark.	Do not just restate the finding.
Evaluate	Strengths and limitations, each with a consequence, plus a judgement.	Do not produce a list of criticisms.

How many marks, how much writing

Marks	Typical demand	Time
2	Two separate points, each developed once.	2–3 min
4	Four developed points — for Asch: sample, roles, public answers, measure + result.	5 min
8	Half AO1 (accurate description), half AO3 (judgement and evidence). Four paragraphs.	10–12 min

Sentence frames 万能句式

Describe: “Asch placed … male students in groups of …, where each naive participant faced … confederates who unanimously gave wrong answers across … critical trials. … % of responses followed the majority's error.”

Explain a variation: “When [change], errors [fell to / rose to] …%, which shows [mechanism], because the only thing that changed was [factor].”

Evaluate: “A strength/limitation is … . This matters because … , which means we cannot … / which strengthens … .”

Marking habit 加分习惯

Every claim needs a **name**, a **year** and ideally a **number**. “Some people conformed” scores 0. “Mori and Arai (2010) found males, but not females, were less swayed by familiar confederates” scores.

Common mistakes checklist 常见错误清单

☐ 把 32% 写成“32% 的参加者”（是 responses） ☐ 把 33.2%（1952）和 32%（1951）张冠李戴

☐ 5.5%（1951 盟友）和 13%（1952 盟友）混用 ☐ 12.8 / 10.4 / 12.5 三个“12”混淆

☐ 评价只列点不给“影响” ☐ 改进题漏了 justification

☐ 说 Asch 证明 ISI（错——证明的是 NSI） ☐ 忘写私下对照组的数字

Dr Fedele replicated Asch's line judgement experiment. Undergraduate participants judged lines in groups where some members were deliberately giving incorrect answers.

Q1 — Identify TWO features of Asch's (1951) procedure that made his test of conformity a strong one. (2 marks)

Q2 — Describe Asch's (1951) study into conformity. (4 marks)

Four developed points: sample · the roles and deception · the public task and trials · the measure and result.

Q3 — Explain one conclusion that can be drawn from the private control group in Asch's research. (2 marks)

Quote the control figure, quote the public figure, say what the difference means.

Q4 — Explain how one variation of Asch's research demonstrates the power of social support. (2 marks)

Name the variation, quote the two numbers, name the mechanism.

Q5 — Identify one improvement to Asch's (1951) study and justify your choice. (4 marks)

Two marks for the improvement (with the weakness it fixes), two for the justification.

Q6 — Evaluate Asch's (1951) research into conformity. (8 marks)

Half the marks for accurate content, half for judgement with evidence. Plan four paragraphs first.

¶	Job of that paragraph 内容	My points 我的要点
1	**Method:** standardised procedure, objective error measure — strength (reliability, internal validity).	
2	**Ecological validity:** trivial task, laboratory — what that does to the conclusion.	
3	**Ethics:** deception and stress — and why they were necessary.	
4	**Sample and stability:** American males, 1950s; Mori and Arai (2010); balanced conclusion.	

Brain dump — close the book 合上笔记盲测

Ten minutes. Write everything you can remember: the 1951 procedure and numbers, all variations with their figures, the 1952 control comparison, the 1956 compromise detail, two strengths and two limitations — from memory only.

pp.2–3 — Task, design, procedure

Setup: laboratory; majority; one; confederates. Task: standard; three; obvious/unmistakable.
confederate — an actor working for the researcher who gives wrong answers on purpose. control group — a group not experiencing the experimental situation, acting as a baseline.
Procedure: 50; eight; three; publicly; one; seven; confederates; unanimously; 12; frequency; interviewed; debriefed.

pp.4–6 — 1951 results, broken majorities, size

32; 68. Correct choice: 32% of responses were errors.
individual; almost; never; confident; individuality; task focus; confidence; fit. Conclusion: combination; situational; individual.
Broken majorities: two → 10.4%; confederate → 5.5%; social support; leaves midway → conformity returns; broke off → hard to switch.
Reading: 32; one; 5.5; unanimity. Don't mix: 10.4 / 5.5 / 12.8.
Size: 1, 2, 3, 4, 8 or 16. 1 → no real influence; 2 → 12.8%; 3 → greatest error rate; larger → no greater effect.

pp.7–8 — Asch 1952

seven; nine; acquaintances; claims the majority's answer is wrong.
33.2; private; 7.4. questioned; right; yielding.
Variations: very obviously → 27.2%; one → completely abolished, challenged; consistently → 13%; sixteen → no impact, mocked and suspected of deliberate error.
Conclusion: yield; questioned; wrong.

pp.9–11 — Asch 1956, side by side

123; seven; second-to-last; 12; moderately; extremely; control.
37; three; one third; moderately; moderate; extreme; four-fifths; one-fifth; compromise; independence; completely.
Discs: disc; 39. publicly; privately; 12.5.
Conclusions: normative; situational; individual.
Side by side: 50 male students, groups of 8; unanimous; questioned; extreme; 32/68; 33.2/7.4; 3; 10.4/5.5/peak; 27.2/abolished/13; modelled/compromise/39/12.5.

pp.12–15 — Numbers, evaluation, improvements

12-sort: 12.8; 10.4; 12.5.
Strengths: same; error → retest reliability, comparisons meaningful; majority → internal validity, confidence the majority caused the errors.
Limitations: laboratory; line → cannot generalise 32% to everyday conformity. deceived; stress; necessary → raises ethical questions but removing deception destroys the procedure. familiar; Mori and Arai; males → everyday conformity depends on who the group is. American; 1950; not → the figure is time- and culture-bound, not a human constant.
Improvements: representative; female; generalisable. realistic; photographs; validity. familiar; everyday.

p.17 — Q1 model (2 marks)

① The procedure was **standardised** — every participant faced the same line judgements in the same way, so conformity was measured objectively through the error rate. ② The use of a **unanimous confederate majority** against a single naive participant created a controlled, unambiguous test of majority pressure.

p.17 — Q2 model (4 marks)

Asch placed **50 male college students** in groups of **eight** and asked them to publicly judge which of three comparison lines matched a standard line. Unknown to **one naive participant**, the other **seven members were confederates** who deliberately gave the same wrong answer, so the participant faced a **unanimous incorrect majority** across **12 critical trials**. The frequency of incorrect responses was the measure of conformity: **32% of estimates followed the majority's error** and 68% were correct. Participants were interviewed and debriefed immediately afterwards.

p.17 — Q3 model (2 marks)

The control group wrote their answers **in private** and erred on only **7.4%** of responses (1952; in 1956, 37 private responders made just 3 errors), compared with about a third of public answers following the majority. This shows the public errors were caused by **social pressure rather than the difficulty of the task** — privately, participants almost never misjudged the lines.

p.17 — Q4 model (2 marks)

When **one confederate consistently gave the correct answer**, conformity fell from around 32% to **13%** (1952; 5.5% in the 1951 ally variation). Because the only change was the presence of one ally, the drop shows that a partner acts as **social support** against majority pressure — breaking the group's unanimity removes most of its power.

p.17 — Q5 model (4 marks)

Improvement: use a more **representative sample** that includes **female participants** instead of just the 50 male students. Justification: this would make his findings about conformity to a majority group more **generalisable** to a wider target population, so we could judge whether the 32% rate applies to women as well.
Alternative: a more **realistic task**, such as photographs of real objects, which would increase the **validity** of Asch's findings about conformity in real-life situations.

p.18 — Q6 model (8 marks)

¶1. A strength is that the procedure was highly **standardised and controlled**: every participant faced the same line judgements in exactly the same way, and conformity was measured objectively through the error rate. This means the study is replicable, so **reliability** can be checked, and the control increases **internal validity** — the error rates were affected only by the majority's answers, and no other variable.

¶2. However, the findings may not extend beyond the laboratory. Conformity to a **trivial line judgement** may occur under laboratory pressure, but real-life conformity involves decisions of greater importance, where the pressure may not exist or may be even stronger. This limits the **ecological validity**, so 32% cannot be taken as a measure of everyday conformity.

¶3. The research also raises ethical problems: participants were **deceived** about the nature of the study and the identity of the group members, and experienced **stress** when giving public answers against a unanimous majority. Asch defended this because the deception was a **necessary part of the procedure** — participants who knew the truth would have acted very differently — but informed consent was still impossible.

¶4. Finally, the sample — **American male university students in the 1950s** — limits generalisation, and later research with different populations has **not produced the same conformity rates**, suggesting conformity is not a stable human characteristic. **Mori and Arai (2010)** used familiar groups and found males, but not females, less likely to be swayed, showing the effect depends on who the group is. On balance, Asch's research remains a convincing demonstration of normative influence, but its figures are specific to its time, task and sample.